NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT

School of Computing & Engineering NIBM | THE CITY UNIVERSITY

	Form ID:	NCRF-ECAF-V1		Version:	1.0
	Form Name:	**Ethical Clearance Application Form**			
	Contact:	Course Director		Date:	
	Notes:	This form is applicable for all undergraduate students enrolled in: BSc (Hons) Computing (Software Engineering), BSc (Hons) Information Technology for Business (ITB), and BSc (Hons) Ethical Hacking & Network Security (EHNS).			
	Compliance:	Ensure compliance with Sri Lanka's Personal Data Protection Act, No. 9 of 2022, where applicable.			
	Approved:			Date:	
	Approval Notes:				

Chairperson
Ethical Clearance Committee
School of Computing and Engineering
National Institute of Business Management
Sri Lanka

Complete all sections. Provide accurate information and follow ethical guidelines. Submit the completed form to the Ethics Committee (ethics-soce@nibm.lk) for approval.

1. Researcher Details

Student Name:	L.P.N.R.R. Pathirana
Student ID:	COBSCCOMP24.2P-053
Student Email:	cobsccomp242p-053@student.nibm.lk
Supervisor Name:	Mr. Niranga Dharmarathne
Supervisor Department:	SOCE
Supervisor Email:	niranga@nibm.lk

2. Programme of Study

Degree Programme (tick one):

- [x] BSc (Hons) Computing (Software Engineering)
- [ ] BSc (Hons) Information Technology for Business (ITB)
- [ ] BSc (Hons) Ethical Hacking & Network Security (EHNS)

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3. Project Details

Research Title: An Explainable Multi-Source Spatiotemporal Model for Accident Hotspot Prediction and Severity Classification in Sri Lanka
Proposed Duration: From April 2026 To October 2026

Brief Summary (Research Objectives):
The research aims to an explainable machin learning framework for traffic accident hotspot prediction and severity classification in Sri Lanka. Historical accident records from Sri Lankan Police and/or insurance companies will be integrated with weather data from external API. The study will use spatiotemporal analysis and XAI techniques to identify accident prone locations, classify road accident severity and determine contributing - factors.

Type of Data to be Collected (tick all that apply):

- [ ] Personal/Identifiable data (e.g., names, contact details)
- [ ] Sensitive data (e.g., health, financial, biometric)
- [x] Demographic data (e.g., age, gender)
- [ ] Interview/Focus group responses (transcripts, audio)
- [ ] Online/Social media data
- [x] Other (specify): Historical traffic accident records, accident location data, accident severity information, vehicle involvement data, ~~anom~~ anonymized casualty information, weather data

4. Ethical Considerations

Does your research involve any of the following (tick all that apply):

- [ ] Human participants
- [x] Use of personal or sensitive data
- [ ] Children or vulnerable groups
- [ ] Psychological stress or discomfort
- [ ] Use of online platforms or social media for data collection
- [ ] Observation without consent in public/private spaces
- [ ] Other ethical concerns (specify): _____

Briefly describe how you will address the ethical concerns:
The study will utilize historical accident records obtained from authorized organizations. No direct interaction with human participants will occur. Any personal identifiable information such as national identity ~~and~~ numbers, vehicle registration numbers, contact details or insurance ~~poli~~ policy information will not be collected or will be removed before analysis. Data will only be used for academic research purposes and all results will be reported in aggregated form to prevent identification of individuals.

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5. Informed Consent

Participants must be fully informed about the nature and purpose of the research. They must consent voluntarily without coercion.

Describe how consent will be obtained from participants (e.g., written, verbal, online):

No direct human participants will be involved in this research. Data will be obtained from authorized institutions such as Sri Lanka police, insurance organizations and publicly available weather APIs. Where required, formal permission will be obtained from the respective data providers before data collection and usage

6. Data Protection and Confidentiality

All data must be collected, processed, and stored in compliance with the Personal Data Protection Act, No. 9 of 2022.

Describe how data confidentiality will be ensured, and how data will be stored, protected, and disposed of:

Data will be stored securely and ~~only~~ accessed accessed only by the researcher and ~~supervisor~~ Supervisor. Any personal identifiable information will be removed or anonymized before analysis to ensure confidentiality. The data will be used solely for academic research purposes and protected through secure storage mechanisms. The data will be retained only for the duration required for the research and university requirements, after which it will be securely deleted.

7. Risk Assessment

Are there any potential risks to participants or researchers? (Y/N): N

If Yes, describe how the risks will be minimized or managed:

8. Supervisor's Approval

Supervisor Name: N. Dharmarathne

Supervisor Signature: _____ Date: 08 June 2026

Comments (if any):

Good to go.

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9. Student Declaration

I confirm that the information provided is accurate. I understand my ethical obligations as a researcher and agree to adhere to NIBM's ethical guidelines **and** the Personal Data Protection Act, No. 9 of 2022.

Student Name: L.P.N.R.R. Pathirana

Student Signature: Nesara Date: 08/06/2026

Proceed.

10/08/26.

10/08/26.